



FIVE

Five questions decide whether your app takes six weeks or six months. Most scoping calls ask none of them.

NOBODY PLANS A SIX-MONTH BUILD.

01 The quote covers what you described

02 The delay comes from what you assumed

03 Nobody asked, so nobody priced it

FIVE
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ASK ALL FIVE BEFORE YOU SIGN.

None of them are technical. Each one either stays a small answer, or quietly becomes a month nobody put in the plan.

01

WHERE DOES THE DATA ALREADY LIVE?

If the answer is "someone else's system", you are not building a screen. You are negotiating an integration, on their timeline.

02

HOW MANY KINDS OF USER?

One kind is a login. Three kinds is a permissions system, and every screen has to know the difference.

03

DOES ANYTHING HAPPEN WHILE THE APP IS CLOSED?

Reminders, sync, anything on a schedule. That is a server, not a screen.

04

DOES MONEY MOVE INSIDE THE APP?

Payments bring refunds, receipts, tax and app-store rules with them. None of that is the payment screen.

05

WHO FIXES IT WHEN IT GOES WRONG?

Somebody needs a way to refund, unblock and correct. That admin surface is a second product.

SAME APP

Before: five answers, given in an hour, priced into the plan. After: the same five, found one at a time, each one already halfway into the build. Same app — a different calendar.



SCOPING A MOBILE BUILD?

Save this and ask all five before you sign anything.

FOLLOW @CODEWITHMASHI

I build mobile for startups and post what actually breaks.